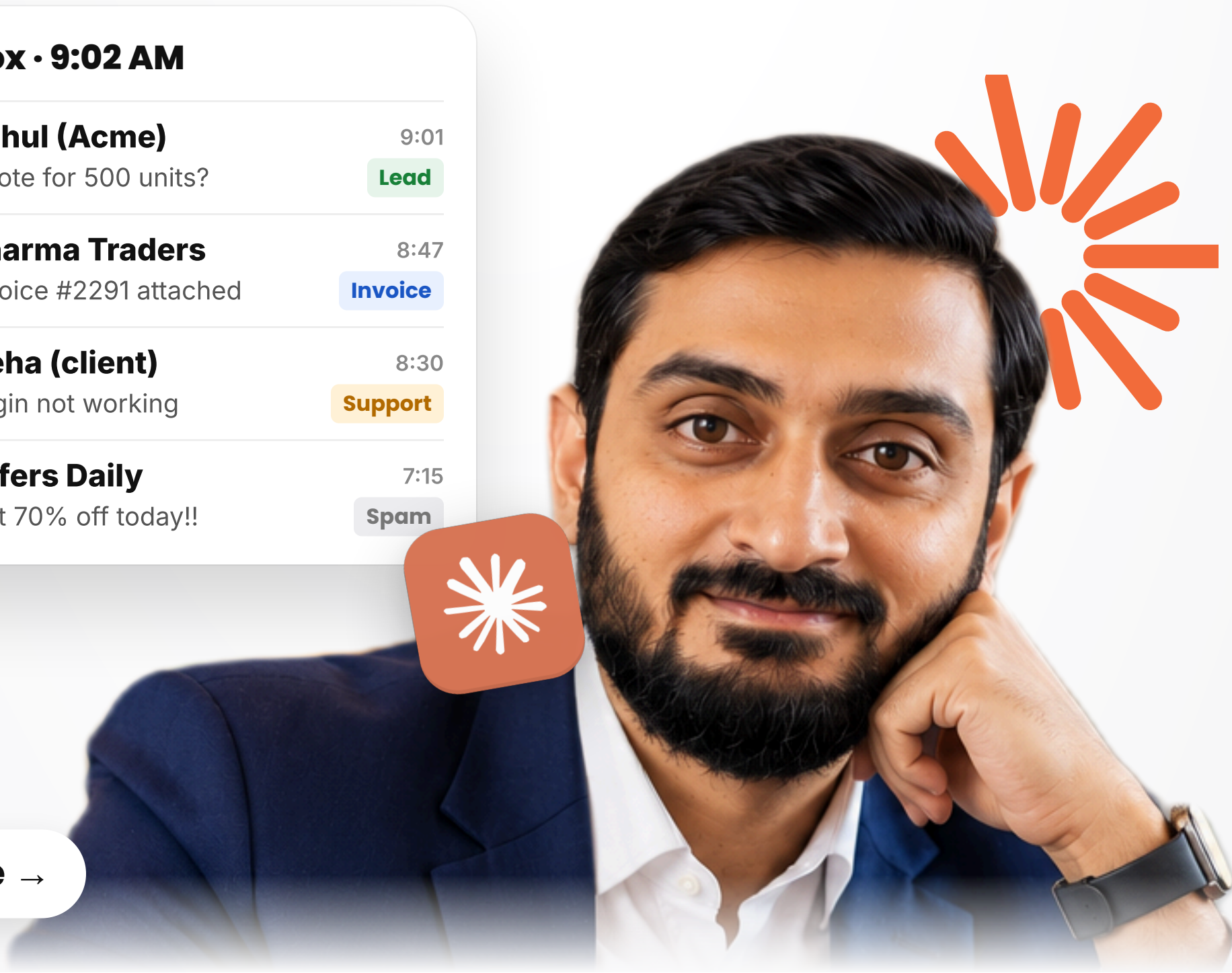
47 unread mails sorted by AI (n8n + Claude)

Inbox · 9:02 AM

RA	**Rahul (Acme)**	9:01	Lead
	Quote for 500 units?		
ST	**Sharma Traders**	8:47	Invoice
	Invoice #2291 attached		
NC	**Neha (client)**	8:30	Support
	Login not working		
OD	**Offers Daily**	7:15	Spam
	Flat 70% off today!!		



Swipe →

The Problem

9:02 AM. 47 unread.

A quote request from a real buyer is sitting between a GST notice, three newsletters and a supplier bill. You find it at 4 PM. They already asked someone else.

Inbox · 47 unread

N	**Newsletter** Your weekly digest	9:00
GP	**GST Portal** Return filing reminder	8:55
RA	**Rahul (Acme)** Quote for 500 units?	8:52 Lead
S	**Shiprocket** Weekly shipping report	8:40
P	**Promo** Last chance: 70% off	8:31

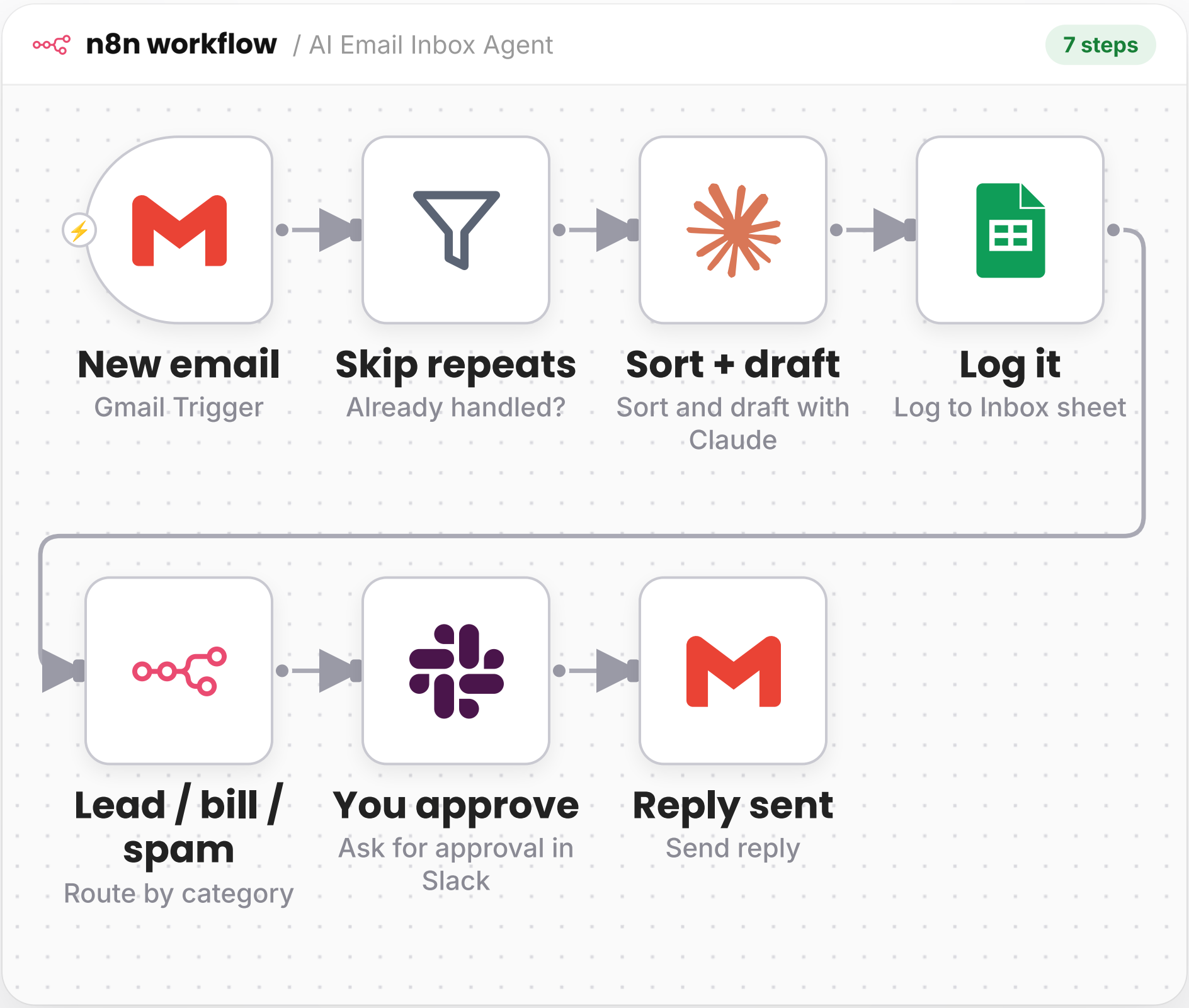


the lead was email #31

The Workflow

AI Email Inbox Agent

Every box below is a node in the free workflow.



Step 1

Catch every new email

Every minute, n8n picks up unread mail, keeps only sender, subject and the new text, and drops newsletters, no-reply senders and anything it has already seen.

- Unread, in Inbox
- Newsletter? skipped
- No-reply sender? skipped
- Seen before? skipped
- Rest goes to Claude

no AI cost for promotions

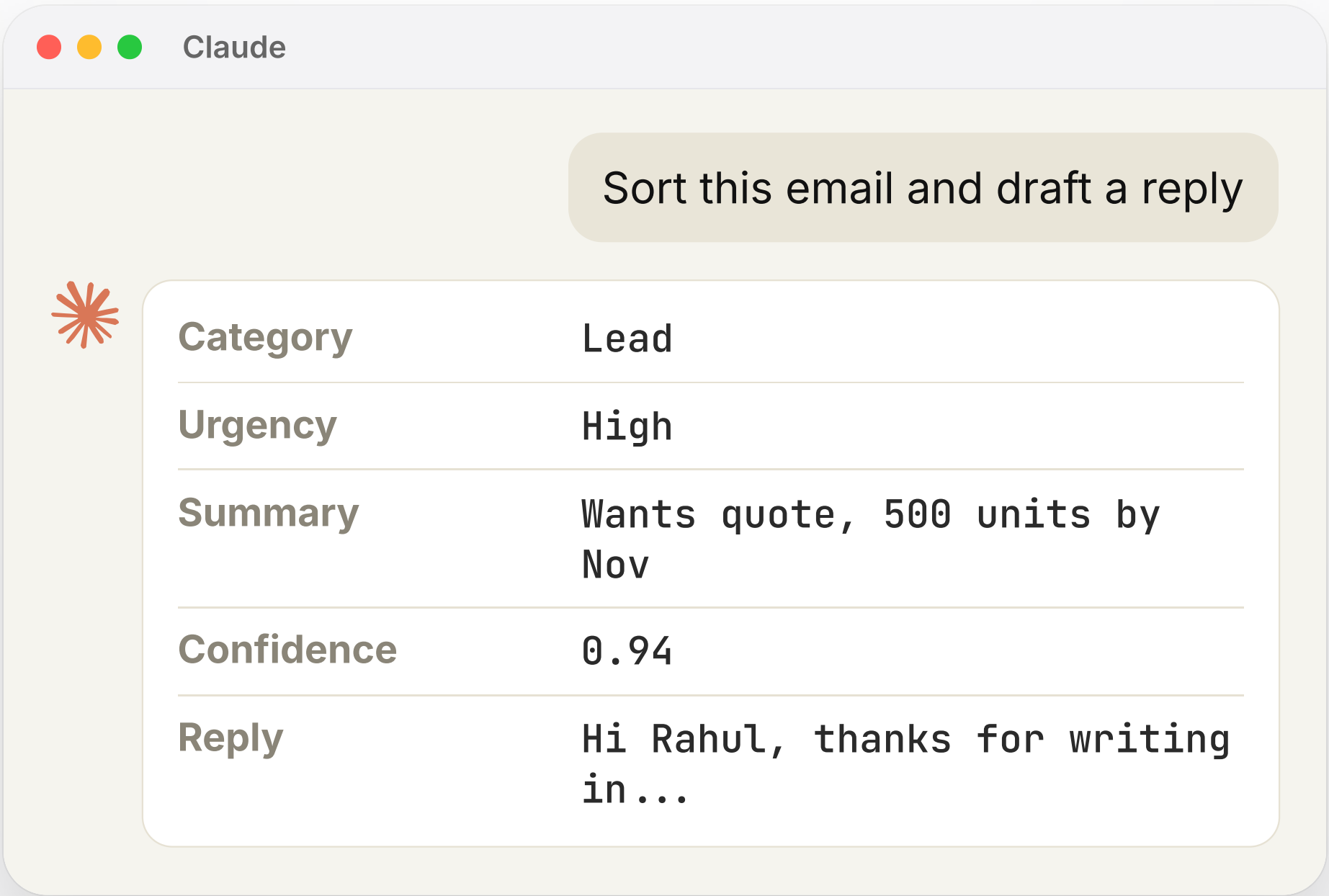
N8N NODES

Gmail Trigger · Clean up email · Skip newsletters and no-reply · Already handled?

Step 2

Claude sorts it and drafts the reply

Claude reads the email and fills fixed fields: lead, invoice, support or spam, how urgent, a one-line summary, and a reply in your tone. Not sure? It files it for you instead.



it writes like you, not like a robot

N8N NODES

Sort and draft with Claude

Combine email and verdict

Step 3

Log it, then file it

Every email becomes a row in your Inbox Log sheet. Leads and support get a Gmail draft in the same thread. Bills get your Accounts label, spam gets an AI/Spam label. Nothing is deleted.

Google Sheets

Inbox Log

	From	Category	Summary	Status
1	**Rahul (Acme)**	**lead**	**Quote, 500 units**	**Waiting**
2	Sharma Traders	invoice	Bill #2291	Filed
3	Neha	support	Login issue	Waiting
4	Offers Daily	spam	Promo	Filed

N8N NODES

Log to Inbox sheet

Route by category

Save as Gmail draft

Label as invoice

Label as spam

Step 4

One tap to send

The draft lands in Slack with Approve and Reject. Approve sends it in the original thread and marks the row Sent. Reject keeps the draft in Gmail. If Gmail fails, you get an alert.

Slack

inbox-approvals

Inbox Agent APP 9:03 AM

New lead from Rahul (high) Wants a quote for 500 units by Nov Draft: Hi Rahul, thanks for writing in. I'll send a proper quote today...

Approve Reject

you stay the one who hits send

N8N NODES

Ask for approval in Slack · Approved? · Send reply · Mark as sent · Mark as rejected · Alert: reply failed

What Changes

Before and after the workflow

BEFORE

- 47 unread at 9 AM
- Leads buried under promos
- Bills lost in the pile

AFTER

- Sorted before you open Gmail
- Leads drafted and waiting
- Bills labelled for accounts

STAYS HUMAN

No email goes out until you tap Approve in Slack. Nothing is ever deleted.



Follow
Makani Tech
for one real automation every day

MT

Makani Tech

Real business automations with n8n + Claude

+ Follow

♻️

Repost

for a founder
who needs this

🔖

Save

for when you
build it

🔔

Follow

a new automation
every day

Free workflow + setup guide

on makani-tech.com/resources

Book a free call → makani-tech.com